lacteals, and from thence it is poured into the general circulation through the blood-vessels.

Whatever residue matter there may be, including that not fit for nutriment, is forced on into the colon, and as the lining membrane in this intestine is no longer supplied with nutritive glands, the contained matter becomes hard and comparatively dry, and is expelled in regular course from the system by the excrementary passage.

It now only remains to add a few words of description concerning the lacteals, through which the thoroughly digested food is ultimately converted into chyle and poured into the general circulation.

The lacteals form part of an extensive fluid system, called lymphatics, of which that portion termed lacteals originates in the mucous membrane of the alimentary canal. Here they are imbedded in the form of villi, or minute tubules, imperceptible to the naked eye; and the chyle, or digested food, in its liquid, milky state, is absorbed into these villi, from whence it passes into larger passages, uniting into great branches, and finally combining into one trunk, called the thoracic duct.

Into this main passage all the lymphatics and lacteals are emptied. Its situation is in front of the second lower joint of the spine, or lumbar vertebræ, and after continuing up the backbone until it reaches a valvular opening, just beneath the clavicle, or collar-bone, it discharges its contents into the left subclavian vein, becomes commingled with the returning currents of venous blood, and is carried into the right cavity of the heart, to be lost in the general circulation.